UNIVERSIDAD AUTÓNOMA DE YUCATÁN

Human Computer Interaction

TraceabilityAtt reflection

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TraceabilityAtt

Learnability is the ease with which specified users can learn to use the specified functions of a product within a given time. It is one of the subcomponents of usability, alongside efficiency, memorability, errors and satisfaction [1].

In the prototype we used “Familiar Navigation and Interface Structure” (adopting common Bootstrap/Material patterns and prioritizing recognition over recall), “Consistent and clear communication,” and a persistent navigation bar with predictable entry points (top-right for notifications/settings); all of these choices are intended to reduce the learning curve and enable a new user to perform basic tasks without training. Concretely, the prototype implements familiar visual patterns such as a persistent top bar, standard icons (for example, a calendar for events) and consistent placement of important buttons, which reduces initial cognitive load. The interface also includes clear labeling and inline validation, with explicit field labels and real-time error/validation messages. Key functions are available directly from the dashboard “Post,” “Search” and “Edit Profile” are visible on the initial view so that a first-time user can complete basic tasks without deep navigation.

In the usability pilot, learnability was measured by combining post-task satisfaction surveys with direct observation of user behavior. These techniques were chosen based on well-known usability metrics: post-task Likert surveys are widely recognized for assessing attributes such as task clarity, ease of completion, understanding of actions, and overall satisfaction. Each participant rated a five-point scale evaluating task clarity, ease of completion, problems understanding what to do, adequacy of feedback, and overall satisfaction.

Both quantitative data (average scores above 4.4 across all dimensions) and qualitative data (observational notes on user behavior, confusion, and reactions) were collected. For example, observations recorded moments of hesitation when filling profile fields, confusion with the search bar placement, or expectations for clearer confirmation after posting offers. These data were chosen because, besides indicating efficiency and clarity, they revealed feedback and confirmation issues that task completion time alone could not capture.

The specific data for measuring learnability were Post-task Likert surveys, Task completion times, as an objective indicator of efficiency in initial use and Direct observation, to document misunderstandings and behaviors not reflected in surveys or times.

Alternative methods to measure the same attribute could include longitudinal retention studies, where users are evaluated on repeating tasks after a period without training; heuristic walkthroughs by experts, which assess learnability based on usability principles; or eye-tracking, to identify interface exploration patterns and potential cognitive obstacles. These alternatives would complement the collected data and provide a more complete understanding of system learnability.

[1] J. Nielsen and H. Loranger, “How to Measure Learnability,” Nielsen Norman Group, Oct. 20, 2019. [Online]. Available: https://www.nngroup.com/articles/measure-learnability/